My Tears Are Watering Roses

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Mature

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Castaspella/Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Castaspella & Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Characters:
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by Minervaas

Summary

Set in the She-Ra universe in which the Spell of Obtainment was never casted. Castaspella is married to the future Head Sorcerer and as such it is expected of her to do her duty. Yet she finds comfort in the place she least expected to, in the company of a young sorceress; Light Spinner.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Castaspella had been married off on the night of the monthly ceremony, as deemed appropriate for marrying the son of the Head Sorcerer. That night, through the Lunarium, the three moons had been shining as brightly as ever, and she had felt like the most beautiful woman when its light fell down on the sewed runestones of her dress. The dress in the colour of the moons almost blinded her eyes with the reflecting light and many had said she had cried from happiness due to that. On her hair with a big runestone a light veil, in the colour of the Head Sorcerer's robes, had been attached, falling all the way to the floor, hiding the back of her head. With her shaky hands she had tied the same colored ribbon around her now to be husband's wrist all the way to his elbow.

All the mags and teachers, all her family and acquaintances were there as she chanted centuries old vows, "May each moon bear my promise…" She wrapped it over, "May the first moon remind me every night that I am yours and I shall stay yours" Her fingers sweaty and unsteady made the light material feel slippery, "as long as the Old Ones' magic runs through my veins.", she brought two ends to meet, " May the second moon remind me every night that I am yours and I shall stay yours as long as the waves meet the shores." A tight knot appeared around his arm as she came to end, "May the third moon remind me every night that I am yours and I shall stay yours as long as this island floats the sky." The ribbon was secured.

Atreyu took the same type of fabric wrapping it now around her bare arm, "May each moon know that I take you by your promises." He twisted the same way she did, the same way they were shown to, "May the first moon know that you shall be mine as long as the Old Ones' magic runs through your veins. May the second moon know you shall be mine as long as the waves meet the shores and may the third moon know that you shall be mine

as long as this island floats the sky." It was knitted tightly on her arm.

She wishes she could say the marriage was as beautiful as the ceremony, but it had only brought suffering upon the young woman. A greater sorrow than that of an arranged, loveless marriage. She wishes she could say she found a friend in a stranger, a safe space in the unknown, but she had only found herself in a role. A role she was not fulfilling well.

As promised he had taken her right that night, as in the tradition of the old royals, under the moons on the cold sand of the empty beach. The waves chanted calmingly and the moons looked down to the sealing of her promises. As followed by the old ways, he took the veil off her head laying it down on the shore. With the runestone from her hair he ripped the back of her dress open, letting it fall to the sand. It was a bad omen to wear it ever again, yet she felt regretful to ruin it in such a way.

The only thing left on their bodies were the purple ribbons, tying their lives together.

Castaspella could tell she was not his first like he was hers, and he was neither gentle nor rough with her. The curls of her hair filled with sand as he went on, and she had wondered how long it would take to clean it all out. The pain had been greater than she expected, but she did not complain and once he was finished, he led her inside the sea. It had been too cold for her preferences, but it was said to bring fertility and so she let him place his hand around her waist, lowering her body until it dipped under the wave. A coldness surrounded her and it was practically unbearable not to suck in the sea like air. The same was not required for the husband and so he pulled her out, only to wrap the veil around

her freezing body. She wondered if he would have done it all the same if the covering was not done by those before them. If it had not been the rule would he have made an exception or let her walk bare to their rooms.

Castaspella had been with child before their second month together even came to be. No bump was visible as of then, but her illnesses had appeared with the pregnancy itself, which had caused some worry, yet every mag had claimed there was no sight to worry. The heir shall be strong, they all predicted, and she, a girl almost two decades mature, was too weak to hold her illness at ease, so they said. The heir shall be strong. Norwyn was more than beaming with such prophecies. Her duty so soon fulfilled.

"The Old Ones must have been content with your promises, Castaspella. It took you far less than my late lady wife." He had told her as he held a feast. Through all of Mystacor there was not a person that did not know that she was with the heir of the heir. Her bump only just three weeks old.

So many had come to see her in those days, her brother and his lady that had a bump of her own. So many witches and mags and sorcerers, future tellers and all. They all chanted the same; *The heir shall be strong. He has the strength of ten dragons.* They would talk more to her husband and his father than her, but she listened nonetheless. Her child shall be a strong heir. *Her child.* Castaspella was not certain how she felt about having one in the first place. She was a mere student just two months ago and now a mother. Sometimes she would lay in bed and wondered if this was the part when she wakes up from her dreams.

Be that as it may, life went on, a week and then another, the moons had been full once again. Moreover the girl’s body had become weaker, her bump barely showing by now. Each day she would throw up more than the day before, and then it suddenly disappeared. The babe is setting, the healers would say and she trusted them. She did all as she was told, grateful to finally eat her favorite sweets.

But the First Ones must have heard her devious thoughts as she woke up that night. The flicker of her husband's candle along with the moons illuminated their room so beautifully, she could see their reflection on her vanity mirror. She moved around to get a better look, yet there was an odd feeling around her thighs. Her hand went under the sheets, touching the inside of her leg just to be greeted with warm dampness. With a curious heart her hand had found itself in front of her eyes in the matter of seconds. A shade of red exchanging the light of the moon.

"Atreyu?", he turned his gaze from his book and he must have seen the confusion on her face and the awkward way she held her hand in the air as he walked to her. He grabbed her wrist bringing it under his eyes, his face scrunching and falling, he let go of it, flying the sheets off her. A small pool of red ruined the perfectly white bed. "What's happening?" Her voice grew shaky as Atreyu moved to the doors.

"We need a healer!" He yelled.

She panicked.

"What's happening, Atreyu?"

He had never answered her. Yet a healer came, but they did not heal her, there was nothing to heal she learned then. "The babe's gone, my lady."

Their marriage was cold and distant, they rarely talked and when they did it was about the weather or the state of the island, random people and random situations. The loss of their first try hanging in the air, creating an even bigger distance.

Before a full week passed by, Atreyu had started to take her again. Though his ways now had been much rougher than the first few times. He did so every night, but she did not complain, despite thinking that her body could use a day or two perhaps even three of uninterrupted sleep. Yet the stress of their duties must have been hard on both of them, not just her, and she understood that.

The guilt of wishing for all to be a dream had eaten her alive, she had not admitted that she thought that just before all had played around, that she had perhaps brought the misery of this to herself. She had stolen a single rose from the gardens, bringing it to the beach. Castaspella threw it in the sea and watched the waves cradle it. A single tear passed her flushed cheeks before she let her nightgown fall. As naked as the day she was born she dived under the waves, the moon her only witness.

Her second pregnancy came around just as her brother received his daughter. A beautiful girl with magical hair. She had been drawn to her from the moment she held her in her arms. Yet she could have not denied a stab in her heart, that her sister by marriage had what she so easily lost.

Her arms rocked the sleeping babe in the robes she had knitted her, "I shall give you a cousin soon.", her palm pressed on her flat stomach, "This one will be heir." She breathed in her angelic smell and soft, tiny hands.

The sweet moment that only she shall remember was interrupted by her brother. "They want to see her." And she gave her back, walking with him.

Brightmoon had been full of visitors, all coming to greet the future queen, including her husband and his father, along with Micah’s friend; Light Spinner. They traveled by magic, which she had dreaded since her illnesses have steadily started to come back. All had made her stomach spin, including the trip and the Brightmoon's cuisine. They didn't even stay the night for her body to rest, before they traveled back causing her to puke out all as they stepped inside their rooms.

She yearned to hold Glimmer once again as she rubbed her upset stomach. "It's no dream." Her voice spoke to the babe that lived in her no more than a week and a half.

Norwyn had fetched for a blind witch that lived further north than the Kingdom of Snow. If the stories were true she could see even the cloudest of futures despite her lack of sight. She had pressed her wrinkled hands on her bare stomach when the babe was already three months old, still kicking the illnesses and killing her sleep.

"This one is special." The witch said. Her nails tracing her in an uneasy way. "It's stronger than the last."

"It is?" A smile grew on her face. "Is it a boy?"

"Strength I see, power-"

"The heir shall be strong." Atreyu interrupted, his face prideful, "I go tell father and you-" He turned to the witch. "Come with me now. You will be rewarded for your good words."

"May the moons look over you child." The witch said, leaving Castaspella to knit her brows, rubbing her growing bump.

Once again the word had spread around, the lady was with the heir, a strong heir it shall be, praised for years to come. Atreyu had started to read her at night, she wishes to say it had brought her pleasure, but all he would read to her were stories of old royals, great warriors and their son was to wear their names.

She didn't care as long as it was a boy, a strong boy like the witch had said. For that she had asked in the Lunarium on the night of the monthly ceremony. Her eyes locked on the moons as she asked for the First Ones to reward her promises with a strong babe. There was a pain in her back from standing on her feet so long. The ceremonies had always been dragged out far too much for her liking, even more so when it had been Glimmer's first one. Though the girl was a mere bundle of blankets in her father's arms.

She leaned on the wall, catching her breath, the soreness in her back grew, seemingly moving through her body. The mags had warned her about random pains, but she didn't have one before this and it surprised her how strong they could be. Nonetheless, she stood leaned on the wall, her hands on her bump as she watched the ceremony with a tight smile. Completely unaware of the drops that were dropping against the marble floors. Truly and utterly foolish to the puddle of red in which her shoes were dipped.

A second rose, she stole from the gardens, was carried away into the endless spread of the sea, the current was strong that night and it moved fast and far. She dived in the moonlight sea, Atreyu had come with her that night and he waited in the sand, her wedding veil laying open once again, their two silky ribbons in his

hand. Her head went under the water, the freezingly cold pain had not bothered her anymore and she rose with grace, yet her face stoic as she walked towards her husband. He stood before her, their eyes never met, their ribbons he started to wrap around her waist. By the old royals, he tied them tightly, from under her breasts to her hips she was covered in the purple fabric that stuck to her wet body. The air felt heavy with it on, but Castaspella never complained, she laid on the veil and locked her eyes with the moons.

Three times they had done this, three full moons, before Castaspella's tan changed from flushed to that of clay. Her eyes painted in dark shades of purple and her stomach spinning like a mill. No witches had come this time, no mags, no nothing, not even her brother knew, cause the child was so short lived, she did not even remember the day it had gone away. Only the rose she had stolen once again.

Atreyu had given up on gentleness and he had given up on tradition. She still bathed under the full moons, but he took her how he pleased, when he pleased. Their times were not reserved only for night anymore, he needed this heir. He never told her anything about the losses, but she knew the way he took her was his way of punishment, of letting out his frustration. She did not need words to know he was angry as was Norwyn. Her one duty and she couldn't bring it to an end.

Micah was worried and Glimmer was growing so fast she couldn't knit that quickly. "I'll give you that cousin. Don't you worry." She'd

whisper to her ears as if the babe had any worries, least of all hers.

Yet as promised her sicknesses came back around. Her Glimmer would get a cousin. Her tan was once again lost and she knew before anyone needed to confirm it to her. And she was right of course. Norwyn wasn't letting this one go, and neither was Atreyu. She was to be controlled under every second, and her condition, whatever cursed thing it may be, was to be put to an end.

As best of the best, Norwyn had pulled Light Spinner out of all the classes she held, cancelled all her private students. It was no secret that the lady kept losing all her babes, that the bumps went but no heir ever came. Yet this was the first time someone outside the three of them was pulled into the matter. Light Spinner's main task as of now was to heal her cursed body and bring this heir to him.

Her illnesses were already wearing her down, her body was slumped over the cushions as the sorceress walked in. It seemed that with each child her body grew weaker.

"Light Spinner." She greeted formally, yet too exhausted to rise up.

"Castaspella." Her voice held no emotions either. They had known each other, but they had been less than acquaintances in her mind.

"I assume they informed you of my presence?" Light Spinner sat herself across from her, she was lacking her usual veil.

"Yes." Embarrassed, she straightened her posture. Her hand falling on her non-existent bump. "A task that must bore such a skilled sorceress like yourself." She was only two decades and six years of age but she already had her own statue in the Hall of Sorcerers.

"I must admit it is not my favorite, but a word from above must not be questioned." Her voice held a not so hidden mockery and Castaspella narrowed her eyes, but smiled gently. She was not wrong, when the Head Sorcerer asked for her hand for his son, her parents did not hesitate, and neither did she. It may have been said as a question, but Norwyn never asked, he only ruled.

Yet she had never talked to someone that spoke so freely. "I do not blame you."

Light Spinner did not answer as her hand was up in the air drawing a curse detecting spell. "You aren't cursed."

"You think I did not check for that?" Her lips made a grimace.

"What happened anyway?" It was the first time anyone had asked her that and she had never conjured an answer before so she simply let her shoulders shrug. "This is your third try?"

"Fourth." She rubbed her stomach. "I need it to work this time, I can't do this again." Castaspella looked her in the eyes, she needed her to understand, "I feel like my body will dry out."

"You look like it."

"What?"

Light Spinner laughed, "You look dried out.", it did not sound like an insult, more like mere observation. No one else had admitted it. "Morning illness?"

"Each time is even worse."

The first day of many to come, they spent in such small words. Each sentence, not more than 8 words long. Light Spinner scrambled them in her brown leather notebook, her hand so gracefully passing over the sand like papers. She had come to know the covers of that book, each crack, she had wondered what she wrote about her in the cursive letters. Did she share her mind with the mags, that her two decades old body was not yet mature, not strong enough to be the mother of the heir? She never asked.

Light Spinner had come everyday an hour after Atreyu would head off. She would always knock princely two times and by the end of the first week she stopped asking who it was. They did not do much in that first week, and she had found herself wondering more than once what the whole point of it had been. The young sorceress would read or write, sipping warm liquids and she would keep her company on the polished oak made table that had been the wedding present from her father. Though they did not speak much then, other than the questions surrounding her past bumps, Castaspella did not mind her quiet company, yet she could have sworn the lady did not take her condition as seriously as of then. It could have been a pleasant change even, if it did not always end in her puke. This time around even the smell of the trays that the maids have carried would send her body spiraling. Shameful, it was.

As the second week was on the horizon, her bump now at one month of growth, the maids did not bring her breakfast. Nonetheless, Light Spinner came, the sounds of knocks filling her empty rooms. She carried with her a bag of herbs that were mesmerizing in smell as soon as she stepped inside, her notebook missing from its usual place.

"What is that?" Her nose had scrunched, not knowing if she enjoyed the scents or not. She dug her fingers in the bag that laid open on the table, but a sting on her fingers, a light slap she received over them, made her pull them away with an *ouch.*

"It's for you." Light Spinner said, moving the bag away from her curious hands. "To drink, not to touch though." As she spoke the

maid brought a warm pot of water, steam flew out of it like from a dragon's nose.

Light Spinner took her usual seat, ripping the herbs in million pieces, filling the mug with it, and pouring them with the burning water causing the smell to intensify. "It looks like poison." She followed her movements like a hawk, uneasy with the thought of drinking it.

"It's peppermint washed in dragon's tears." Her face was still uncertain as the mug was placed in front of her.

"You won't drink?"

"I'm not wasting this on me." Light Spinner hissed, "First Ones, I'm not poisoning you." Yet Castaspella could tell her gaze must have still screamed distrust as the woman took a sip out of the mug before giving it back. "It's for the illness. Drink up."

"It looks like it will make me more sick." Her fingers wrapped around the mug, "It's too hot."

"It's meant to be drunk that way."

With a sigh she took a sip burning her mouth and throat, the tastes making her feel like her airways opened up. "Must I truly drink this?" She drank the whole thing nonetheless, her insides

burning with warmth. Only then had the maids brought her breakfast, which she by then did not want. "I'm not hungry." She told the young girl, but Light Spinner raised her fingers rushing her out before she could take the plate away.

Oh how she cursed her as the sun set at its highest point and she kneeled over the bucket releasing the breakfast she did not even want in the first place. "It can't work in a day, Castaspella." She helped her up, and they sat on the balcony, basking in the winter sun, her thoughts still sceptical. "Give it time." As if reading her like one of her books, she said. Her eyes closed with a nod, her fingers gripping her stomach as the sun warmed her ghost-like face. Unawaringly slumber took her over.

When she woke up Light Spinner had still sat in the same place, her eyes looking over the fence towards the gardens. "How long was I out?" Long, judging by the wary sound of her voice.

"Some time."

"Are you sure you did not poison me?"

Light Spinner chuckled, loudly, her luscious hair moving in its rhythm. "I might if you don't stop giving me ideas."

"What are you looking at?" She straightened herself from the uncomfortable position, trying to look down the fence too, to the place Light Spinner's eyes were glued to.

"Some fool keeps demolishing my roses." Castaspella's eyes found the dark red bush of roses. A blush reappeared as half of it was missing its flowers. Last week she had sneaked into the gardens again, cutting three roses, the prettiest she could find and she gave them to the sea, in hopes her lost bumps might let this one live. In total she had taken six roses.

"I-" she cleared her throat, "I must apologize then." Light Spinner looked at her with narrowed brows, "For demolishing your roses." She could not read her face well.

"You ruined my roses?"

She nodded as the woman grew an unbelievable smile. "I had not realized how much I took or that it belonged to someone in particular."

"Why would you even go around plucking flowers?"

"I gift them to the sea…" She rubbed her stomach in circles, "for my late babes and this one and those ones were the most alluring ones."

Light Spinner nodded, "You follow the old ways?" She did not seem angry, but yet again she did not seem like anything really.

"Yes, you do not?" She shook her head, "Then you must think of me as ridiculous."

Light Spinner never confirmed her accusation, she had been a woman of a few words, or at least it seemed like it. She came back the next morning all the same, with her herbs and her notes, they repeated all. The tea, the food, the puking, the winter sun and her slumber. When she would open her eyes, they'd always be met with her raven head stuck in something, be it the horizon or her notes, the old books or the newest flyers. Sometimes she'd go back, stealing a few more minutes of sleep when her nights were so restless, the other times she'd try to indulge them in a conversation. Though most of their time in the first month had been spent in a light silence.

Her babe now two months at growth had slowed down the illnesses, yet what she did not know was that it would not be long lived. Light Spinner had ensured that she still had a single glass of the tea, believing that all her wellness was due to that and not the heir settling in her womb, accepting his duty to come. Their opinions clashed more than once, but she always listened to her, wanting to see her own duty through.

Castaspella's tan had stayed the same clay colour despite her improvement of appetite and the sorceress had not seemed practically content with it. "You bask in the sun all day yet you still look horrendous."

"There's no need to worry." She'd tell her, though she lived with constant fear in her chest, "The illnesses are gone and the babe is

still here. I am alright."

"I shall hope so or it will be my head on those spikes." The weight of her duty seemed to have taken Light Spinner under its wing too. She knew the woman spoke the truths nonetheless, they'd both suffer if this heir does not come.

"Can we go down to the beach today?" Like that she would always find a way to switch the conversation, "If I spend one more day in these rooms I might as well go crazy."

"As you wish."

So she had finally found herself out and about, the word still hadn't spread and the bump was barely coming to show under her flare gowns. The beach was empty at such a daft time and she was at peace. Though Light Spinner had refused to even let her set the blanket down, or carry the bags or do anything. "I'm not having a discussion with Norwyn for letting their *princess* do such things, so you might as well shut up now."

"So scared of Norwyn?" She laid down at the shore, for the first time since she got married, there was nothing expected of her in this place.

"I'd rather say I'm saving up my nerves." The sorceress sat down, joining her, "I'm already spending them like crazy on you."

"You can not say I'm truly such a bad company." The waves welcomed them with their loud harmony. "I leave you be…most of the time." A dusty book was set on Light Spinner's lap and she watched her tentatively for a few moments.

"Perhaps I'd rather be somewhere else, doing something else, than sitting here keeping you company."

"Perhaps I'd rather be somewhere else, doing something else too." She bit her tongue quickly, "Aye, First Ones forgive me." Her heart was racing for having said such devious thoughts, what if she loses the babe again. "I shouldn't have said that."

"Why not?" Light Spinner's green eyes looked down on her. "I'm not offended by any means."

"I don't want my words to be taken wrongly." Her hand gripped at her bump, the sun was getting in her head, her eyes heavy. She found herself moving closer to the sorceress, her presence had brought a sense of safety and she could not sleep at night despite her husband being nearby. Her eyes fell shut once she was mere fingers away from Light Spinner.

“Could you braid my hair?” She asked her on a sunny day as she sat in the meadows above the beach, Light Spinner tended to her

plants and she read. “It’s too warm.” the front strands of her hair got stuck against the sweat of her cheeks.

“You can not do it yourself?”

“It looks sloppy when I do.” Her warmth appeared behind her back, but Castaspella did not lift her head from the faded words of her book. Her skilled fingers ran through her hair, pulling it away from her flustered skin. It took her quite a bit to get to the end, yet she had enjoyed the feeling of gentle brushes, the twists of her strands. She had not minded her warmth even under the sun, completely lost in the story in front of her to feel the light weight of the daisy flowers in her finished braid. “Thank you.” Her own fingers touched the work, "You put flowers in my hair?"

"I can take them out if it's not to your liking."

"No, no." She turned around, pressing her lips to Light Spinner's cheek that was not as close to warm as her own. "It's lovely. Thank you." she turned to her book once again, letting the sorceress put her gloves back on, going back to her plants.

Atreyu had taken her to the next monthly ceremony despite her wish not to go. She had not been to one since she lost her second babe. The one she had the highest hopes for. It had been so hard to lay her eyes on the same wall it had happened at. Or to hear the light whispers that followed her. To remember the way her

eyes had found the bloody puddle under her feet. Her heart rose to her throat, her eyes prickled. *Please, make it strong.* She begged the First Ones once again.

Her body had fallen sick that same night, a fever so strong holding her glued to the bed, damping her sheets in sweat. She must have been mumbling nonsense in such a state for Atreyu's candle had been lit, and he must have complained as Light Spinner had exchanged his presence in their rooms. She felt bad that someone had gone to fetch her despite the late hours.

"Figure out what's wrong with her now!" Atreyu's voice kept pulling her out of her feverish dreams, "You're the one that's with her every second. Fix this!" A loud slam of wooden doors and Light Spinner had found herself in their bed.

Her cold hands hurt against her warmed up skin and she whimpered pleadingly, "Light Spinner." Searching for her hand until it met hers and she gripped it so desperately, her tears falling like a river drying out.

"It's just a fever." Her free hand conjured circular spells over her. The heat fell in a matter of minutes, but Castaspella still gripped the hand in her grasp. "It's over now." She was not letting go. Light Spinner was safe, and she was powerful, she would make sure her babe stayed. So she slept with their hands connected, her muscles tightened in shock and fearfulness.

"Light Spinner." She whimpered on through the night, never letting go, not in her sleep and not in her awakeness. “Light

Spinner.”

Surely enough, Castaspella’s fever was just a fever, but with that night her illnesses have reappeared from the pit of her gut. It did not matter how much tea she’d chunk, she’d kept getting sicker and sicker. A bucket for her stomach now an obligatory company to the two of them.

“Light Spinner.” She grabbed her attention, pulling the woman out of the books she had started to read even more, her lips licked at the last drop of tea. “Have you ever seen a dragon?”

“Once or twice.” Her book closed with a loudness, and she eyed her curiously, “Each fire princess is gifted a dragon egg at birth.”

“I’ve never met a fire princess.”

“They are closed off people, closer to their dragons than us. I was there once, it’s how I saw the dragon…and got the tears in which your tea is made.”

“They said my first babe had a strength of ten dragons.” Light Spinner’s eyebrow rose at her, “How strong would that be?”

“I can not begin to imagine such strength.”

“Hmm…” Without satisfaction she lowered her back into the chair.

“Give me your hand.” Light Spinner said, stretching her arm and she listened. Her palm laid openly over hers and it tickled as she drew a spell with her index finger. A spell she had not seen before, but was nonetheless in awe as a picture, an illusion, danced on her skin. A red dragon spinned on her hand, it was not bigger than an apple, its weight nonexistent. Her smile grew as it puffed a fire that did not burn before bursting into blue sparkles.

“Did the dragon you saw looked like that?” Light Spinner nodded, her eyes narrowed as the rest was hidden by a veil. “So you just pulled that from your memories?”

“Mostly.”

Her happiness fell though as the dragon went away just like her bumps. “Will you know soon what is wrong with me?”

“When the babe is more grown.” Her head returned back to the heavy books.

Atreyu had traveled to Dryl in the days before the babe was turning five months old. Her sleep, though it had not once been

truly peaceful with him, turned a horrendous turn. Her heart beat hard against her chest and she had frozen on her sheets, not wanting to move one inch. Her eyes though heavy could never fall shut for more than a few minutes, her hands constantly on her stomach. So on it had gone until the late hours of the morning when Light Spinner walked in as if walking into her own bedroom, no sounds of knocking following her. Castaspella still laid in her sleeping gown, the sheets pulled all the way to her chin.

"Are you under a fever?" Light Spinner asked, her belongings forgotten on the desk as she walked closer to the bed.

She shook her head, her eyes like rocks, "I did not get an hour of sleep."

"Ah, the babe must miss its father." The sorceress sat down next to her.

She had found her heart to calm down and she let her eyes rest. "Can I have tea later than usual?" With a yawn she spoke her words.

"You may do as you wish, Castaspella."

She stayed close to her though, sitting in a little chair next to the bed, reading her books and writing her notes, as her dreams spilled into the late afternoon. The worries of the night disappeared, until her father by marriage had come to see her,

finding it none wiser for a future mother to not be resting during the nights, sleeping through the healthy sun and fresh air instead.

"Head Sorcerer." Light Spinner bowed to him lightly as she herself could only rest against the frame of the bed.

"The lady should not be sleeping at such an hour, Light Spinner. I have expected far more from you." His hands laid on her bump, she wondered if it was too strong for it.

"I have not gotten my rest last night, Head Sorcerer." Her own hand laid across his, her eyes on the woman, "Light Spinner was kind enough to let me catch some. Perhaps, it would even be in the babe's best interest if she could watch over it during the nights to come. I'm worried it might be stressed over its father's absence." He did not seem to take her words in as much as she wanted him to, "I do not wish for anything to happen to the heir, having someone near would do him good."

He nodded, "You speak wisely, girl." And she smiled. "The heir shall be strong." His hands moved away from the bump, away from her. "Light Spinner."

"Head Sorcerer." Then he was gone as rapidly as he came, "Must you have made my work even longer? There were far better excuses."

"I speak the truth." She let their eyes lock, "You are responsible for the heir's safety, it's better for it if you're here."

When the moons appeared in the sky, Light Spinner still stayed, her body gracefully resting in the chair as she found her place in the bed. Due to her afternoon's rest she did not feel as tired anymore, and she laid on her side watching the sorceress. "You will not sit there all day and night, will you? I'll feel great guilt if you do."

"I do not see what else is there to do." She did not seem content with today's change.

"Please" Her hand tapped the empty bed, "rather lay here, I do not care if you sleep or not, read if you must, but you will hurt yourself in those chairs."

"Do not worry for me." The sorceress spoke with a flat tone, but she kept piercing her eyes at her, the same way she used to do at her brother when he would catch her in trouble's ways. It worked always, even now.

"Thank you." She gravitated towards her, stretching her hand to the woman's. "For all."

"I'm merely doing my duty. Do not thank me."

"Light Spinner?" Her voice called for the green eyes, continuing only once they met hers. "I think the babe likes you."

Castaspella was never certain if she slept or not, because she would always fall asleep as soon as the sorceress joined her bed and she'd always wake up once the smell of the tea would fill the room. Despite her constant puking she had felt well rested and most of all safe.

On the fourth night, her bump had entered its fifth month. It was growing enough to finally start untying the mystery of her condition and it seemed that Light Spinner did not want to miss one second of her precious time. They laid, she read her books as Castaspella herself knitted pink and purple yarns, exchanging them as she thought of her little Glimmer that kept growing at lighting's speed. The sorceress closed her books before she was even halfway to what she planned on knitting that night. She could even feel her eyes on her, but she didn't want to look up and mess up the tiny shirt. Yet her heart beat with uncertainty at such odd behaviors. She knitted on for a whole infinity before the sorceress spoke.

"May I see your bump?" Castaspella had not even noticed how close she came to be until her question came.

Her head agreed where her words had stopped working, so worried that Light Spinner had found something to be at odds with her babe. Hurriedly she pulled the sheets past her bump, her fingers undoing the knot on her gown before the sorceress hand had dropped on them. "You can go on with your knitting."

She listened, though her eyes had curiously looked from behind the yarn.

Light Spinner's hand finished where she started, untying the silky gown moving it right and left enough for her bump to come through. Her heart was loud and fast as the woman's thin fingers collided with her skin, tracing her stomach. Soon her whole palm moved over it, her touch was gentle, welcoming. It chilled through her a sense of security. She messed up the yarn.

Her fingers grew blue, but her touch still as light as a feather, the green of her eyes disappearing under her eyelids. Yet her brows moved closer together and her lips grimaced and she had found herself afraid once again. The glow on her hands died out with a quiet gasp.

"What's wrong?" Her own voice seemed like nothing but a gasp, as Light Spinner started to close her dress again.

Their eyes met, but they needed words to speak, "It truly is strong. I have never felt magic like this." Her eyes watered, all her babes were said to be strong, yet she had taken her words to heart, but completely lost on showing it.

"The heir shall be strong."

The word spread once again, Norwyn too impatient to wait for the babe to be here. People had come from all over Etheria to get a glimpse at another one of her bumps. Everyone always acted like the next one was the first one. Though Light Spinner had never once left her post, she missed when it was just the two of them,under the sun, no prophecies.

"The fire princess Elvira is here, my lady." One of the maids had said. The princess followed right behind her and her tea was left abandoned.

"Light Spinner." The princess with her fire like hair and icy eyes spoke, a light smile on her tiny lips.

"Princess." The sorceress bowed.

"Must there always be a need for such formalities, dearest?"

"I see you did not lose your wit." The princess laughed, discarding her gloves on the oak table.

"My lady." She turned to her then, bowing in respect and Castaspella returned the favor, "May the heir be strong. Correct me if the expression is wrong, I must admit I do not know much of your ways."

"All is well. To what do I owe the pleasure of your visit? I never had a visitor from your lands."

"We stick to our dragons, my lady." The princess turned to Light Spinner again, her smile big, "My dear friend had written to me, it has fallen to my knowledge that you are yet to see a dragon." She nodded, "Well my dragon rests on the outskirts of the beach, you're welcome to see her, though I must say I will not be staying past the nightfall."

"I do not know what to say." Her heart beat with excitement as Elvira bowed to her.

"Light Spinner, it was a pleasure seeing you. You'll know with Gyrria, if the lady decides to visit?"

"Have no worries, Elvira."

Just like that the dragon that danced on her palm weeks ago now stood before her very eyes. It was far bigger than an apple, she would say as big as Mystacor's castle even. To just stand next to it warmed the air, small steam exhaled from its nostrils. It glowed with its red scales and gold eyes.

"It will not burn us alive?" She had asked Light Spinner that stood with her shoulder to hers.

"It is said dragons remember everyone they've ever met. She is a claimed dragon, she can smell her rider on us. She will not hurt us unless we hurt her." The sorceress moved closer, the dragon's breath caused her hair to dance around. "I understand if you do not wish to move closer." She placed her hand against the scales with the same light in which she touched Castaspella's bump. The dragon did nothing, lying peacefully, and she dared to walk closer. Her babe was to bear ten of its strength. So she placed her own hand against its warm side and Light Spinner looked down at her with a smile, the sorceress moved, layering their hands, pressing hers more firmly to the dragon. The fear evaporated from her.

Later that night they watched from the balcony as it flew away. Its wings were so long and strong they caused a rush of waves on the sea, a black silhouette over the moons. A tear passed across her face and she pressed her arms over her heart. "Thank you, Light Spinner."

"Have you thought of a name?" The sorceress had asked as they enjoyed the warmth of the beach, her feet dipped in the sea.

"Atreyu did; Rhunton."

"God of the moon?"

She nodded, "Like the first Head Sorcerer." a wave covered her ankles. "It is said he rose Mystacor from the other kingdoms bringing it closer to the moons, to the First Ones."

"I know." Of course, she did, "What if it's a girl?"

"It won't be a girl." Her hand had found itself over her growing bump. "Girls aren't heirs."

"In some places they are." Light Spinner quickly shot her words. As skilled as with her magic.

"Not here."

"No, not here." She could feel her move closer, and surely a pile of sweet strawberries was set in her lap.

"I'll get ill."

"The babe needs food."

Her fingers picked one up, "I doubt it wants it." She bit into it nonetheless. It's sugary taste refreshing her dry lips. Light Spinner was close enough for her to rest her back against and she did so, letting the strawberries paint her lips and the chilling sea cool her feet. "I think the babe loves it most at the beach."

Her airy chuckle warmed her ear. "The babe or you?" Light Spinner's hand rested on her bump, and she moved her own to let her have enough space.

"I said the babe."

"How do you know what it likes?" Her palm moved in a half circle, it felt as nice as the first time she touched it.

"When I'm least ill and most calm." A second fruit rested on her lips, "I think then it likes something. It likes the beach, the sun, it likes you." Light Spinner chuckled again. "You don't believe hmm?" She dropped her hand on the sorceress' leg with a quiet tap as a friendly punishment. "I could have your tongue for not believing me."

"My lady, I did not say a word, did I?" She hummed, biting her third strawberry, "Your babe radiates so much magic, it's unbelievable still."

"Many had said similar things to me, but I have come to believe only your words, Light Spinner." Her hand lingered over the sorceress', keeping her safe touch over her bump, "I did not have much hope for this babe to stick until you started poisoning me with your teas. For some reason, believe it or not, the babe has settled since you came." Light Spinner did not answer, but her blue magic tingled over her bump and the strawberries had not come out of her, filling her stomach.

Her bump was six months old when Light Spinner had asked her a question she dreaded was coming. "How did you lose your babes?"

Her shoulders shrugged, her eyes staying on her needles, on her dark purple yarns, "The first bump was merely weeks old, it did not hurt or anything. I woke up. I remember the moons, they were so bright and full, I wanted to get a better look but I felt it then…" She stopped for a second, wondering if she should admit to the thoughts she had just before that night, but she didn't. "I touched it with my hand and it came back bloody, I wasn't aware yet, but when Atreyu threw the blankets off, when I saw his face… The second one I really thought it was the one. It was during the ceremony, it was painful this time around, but I thought I was imagining. The next thing I know everyone's whispering, looking at me, and I looked down and there it was just-"

"I was there." Light Spinner said, her hands writing down in her thick notebook, she still did not have enough courage to ask her what she wrote of her in it.

"I don't remember the third one."

"What day was it?"

"I could not say. I'm sorry."

Light Spinner closed her notes. "It's okay." Her eyes were the same colour as her tea, "Perhaps some things are better forgotten."

"Perhaps." Nonetheless, she felt guilt for forgetting, for never having the memories of those days in the first place.

"The other ones were both on full moons?" Castaspella had not connected that, though so obviously, "And you have gotten sick after that ceremony…" She had truly and her illnesses still bothered since.

“I did not notice.” She sipped her tea faster.

They walked down the corridors, finding their way to the Lunarium through the familiar path, they’d be late for the ceremony just because of her daft puking. “First Ones, why is it on the other end of the palace?” Her breathing was heavy and her words broke at half in between her inhales.

“We’ll manage.” Light Spinner spoke with ease as if the two of them did not walk the same speed, as if she was merely levitating while Castaspella ran and she felt it then. Like a bubble it moved through her bump, but she ignored it, quickening her pace.

“I don’t want to be late.”

“No one will notice even if we are.”

It swirled in her, her heart beat faster, she tried to swallow it down, walk faster. Yet her hand found itself on the first wall. “Ahh…” A stab in her womb and she clenched her stomach in fear. The moons were full. “No, no.”

“Castaspella?” Light Spinner’s hand found itself on her upper arm, but she could barely feel her there. Her mind on one thing and one thing only. “Casta?”

She moved frantically, grabbing at her dresses, desperately lifting them though they kept falling in heavy layers, it made sweat break through. Light Spinner’s voice kept rumbling in the back and she finally managed to lift her clothes enough to slide her hand underneath it. There was no dampness between her legs, her hand coming back the same way as it went under. Light Spinner’s voice came back to her brain.

“Something’s wrong.” She looked straight into her tea like eyes, “Don’t let it go.”

“What’s wrong? Calm down.” Light Spinner held her arms still, tightening her grip until she finally let her dress fall.

“There is pain.” She grabbed her hand pressing to where the flutters came from. “Here.” And the sorceress’ face changed from worry to a smile causing her to knit her brows. “Why are you smiling? This is serious.” Her fingers pressed her further.

“Your babe is simply saying hello.”

“Have you gone mad?” Her voice shook, “Light Spinner!”

“Did the healers and mags not explain anything to you?” The movements still went on, “The babes move inside the womb. It is what you are feeling right now.”

“Are you certain? This does not feel normal.” Light Spinner moved even closer, pressing her lips to her sweaty forehead, her fingers glowed in the familiar shade of blue. The flutters turned back to bubble like movements until they fully disappeared. She let go of her bump, her hand on Castaspella’s warm cheeks.

“Let’s go back to your rooms.”

She got used to the babe’s hellos in the following weeks, but she loathed when they’d happen in the late hours of the night. She loathed when Light Spinner was not there to soothe it if she did not like how long it went on. She loathed when she was not there to convince her it was just the hellos. The babe loved her magical touches, her blue glowing fingers.

"I know what's wrong!" Light Spinner walked in on the morning of the next ceremony, her babe over 7 months old, her bump heavier than ever.

"What?" She rubbed her stomach looking at her with big eyes.

"Come here." The sorceress called for her and she could not lie and say a fear did not rise in her. "Conjure a spell."

"What spell?"

Light Spinner was practically frantic, "Whichever you want. Come on."

"I-Okay." She drew her own blue sparkles, but when she tried to shape them in a circle it kept glimmering until it busted into nothing, no spell coming to life. With a fuss she tried again, this time her sparkles barely glowing. "What-"

"The babe" Light Spinner's hands found themselves on the sides of her bump, her thumbs running circles, "It steals your magic."

"I don't follow."

"Your babes steal your magic, almost like they feed on it so to speak." She lets her fingers glow in that soothing way, "Your body sees this as a threat leading to the losses."

"So it's my fault?" It had been all this time, she was too weak to carry the heir.

"No. It's nothing one can control or something one can predict. Babes rarely ever need magic to grow. But yours are strong."

"What's different this time?"

"The dragon's tears they sated the babe somewhat, it needs less of your magic, and this." Her fingers danced over her bump still, "It takes this too. It's why it likes me as you say, it likes my magic. Somehow it's strong enough to sense it."

Castaspella shook her head, "No, it likes you, not just your magic."

"Don't be ridiculous. Now we know why."

She pushed her hands away. "It likes *you* and the sun and the beach. Yes, it likes when you do that magic thing, but it also just likes your presence."

Light Spinner moved closer, her hands finding their place once again, and she smiled down at her in a way that she did not know if she believed her or not.

She kept shimmering her magic over her everyday. Even Atreyu had begun to do the same, his magic never felt as calming, but the effect was still the same. Before she knew it her illnesses had fully disappeared, her clay colored tan slowly turning flustered. Light Spinner had done so much good for her babe and for Castaspella herself, that she was not sure how she could ever repay her. Let alone ask of her what had started to bother her mind as weeks went by.

"Light Spinner." The woman hummed as she tended to her roses. "I need to ask something of you." Her green eyes looked over the shoulder, studying her face before deciding it was serious enough to sit next to her.

"What is it?" Castaspella searched for her hand, taking it in both of hers.

"My fear grows. You have done so much for me, but I hear what people say, fellow princesses, healers…"

"What have you heard?" Light Spinner's free hand played with Castaspella's hair, moving the strands that fell in front of her face.

"What do you fear?"

"I've heard what they do to women like me." One of her close friends had recently died of birth, the baby lived. "When there is struggle."

"I fear I don't follow you, Casta." Her eyes averted, looking at her fingers that held that slim hand.

"It's not talked about unless you know someone that knows someone." She could sense Light Spinner wanted her to get to the point. "We both know I don't exist above duty, my marriage is for a simple reason." Their eyes met once again, "If there are difficulties at birth, they have found the way to save the heir."

"A spell?" She shook her head.

"They cut to the womb. "

"What do you mean they cut?" Light Spinner's eyebrows narrowed "Where did you hear this?"

"I meant what I said." She tried to keep her voice firm, but the fear was there, "Atreyu will not hesitate to do the same. We-He needs this heir, Light Spinner. He won't hesitate to let them do the same to me, and I…I do not want to die such a painful death."

Her fingers gripped her hand, "I want you to be with me when this babe is due."

"If that is your wish I will be there."

"Light Spinner." She could feel her lips tremble, "If it comes to it, please, put me under a sleeping spell. Don't let me die in such a way."

"No one will cut you open, Casta. Don't listen to old witches' gossip."

"Promise me." Her hand squeezed hard, her eyes burning into her, "Promise me this."

"I promise. Now enough of this." Light Spinner rose from the blanket going back to her plants.

"My lady, the babe's coming." Her maid said, voice filled in worried, "Should I fetch for your husband, they are dining-"

"Fetch me Light Spinner." She let the top layer of her dress fall down, "And the healers. Then you do as you wish." The maid bowed before hurrying out.

Castaspella's breath was stuck in her throat, she was not ready for this. The healers came first, yet she refused to let them touch her. Cold sweat prickling around her hairline. Her teeth gritted with every new pain.

"My lady, you should lay down." The healer told her as she stood hunched over the oak table, her hand holding at her bump. Even in the light underdress her skin was burning.

"Light Spinner." She lifted her head as the doors opened, "Lock the doors." And the sorceress listened before she was by her side. She exchanged the table for her hand, squeezing it with a whimper. "I can't do this, Light Spinner."

"You can." She felt the fingers brush over her damp hair. Light Spinner led her to the bed and she cursed in pain. Never letting go of her hand. The healers moved between her legs, her beige dress thrown over her knees. Yet nothing happened no matter how many times she squeezed the hand or how many times the grunts left her. The pain grew stronger with each pass of time.

The doors shook with knocks, "Castaspella!" Atreyu and Norwyn's voices mixed behind the heavy wood. She screamed louder, all parts of her body tensing as her head arched back. Her body was drenched in sweat, her hand in a death grip with Light Spinner's. She used it to lift herself up, letting her dress fall once again.

"My lady-" The healer touched her knee, but she moved away. Standing now on her two legs that could barely keep her up.

She talked to Light Spinner only, meeting her eyes that lacked that warmth, "Balcony. I want to go-ahh…"

"Are you sure that's what you want?" Her voice was contradictory but they moved nonetheless and she let go of her hand for the first time. Grabbing the railing, she whimpered, the moons were full. The voices were still yelling in the hall, it gave her an even greater panic.

"First Ones!" Her fingers were stones against the fence, the waves were crashing in the distance. Light Spinner's fingers lingered over her lower back.

"My lady, the Head Sorcerer wants to come in-" The healer stepped closer.

"NO!" The back of her throat burnt from her screams, "Just move. FIRST ONES!" She let go of the rail, of Light Spinner, moving back inside, clutching at her bump, at the walls, clenching her dress. She could not stand still, moving, every few steps grabbing onto something else. Be that as it may, her body could not follow even such a pace and her knees hit the ground, her hand grabbed at the bedframe. Light Spinner was sitting next to her in a matter of moments, she did not touch her. "Remember your promise." Her tears spilled freely. The front doors still shook.

"Castaspella."

"Tell me you remember!" Light Spinner nodded, mumbling something she could not hear due to her own scream. "First Ones!" She could barely catch air. "GET OUT!" Her hands pressed on her bump. She could not hold her head straight any more.

Light Spinner grabbed her arms, lifting her off the cold floors, "Come." The sorceress sat on the bed, pulling her along until her back was pressed against the soft chest. She held her hand, their cheeks touching and she knew Light Spinner motioned for the healers to come, as they once again moved around her. She whispered in her ear, about the beach, and the sun, about her winter roses and Castaspella cried and screamed, squeezing her hand, she whispered of dragons and moons, the old royals.

Then the babe cried, it cried and the front doors stopped shaking and she stopped screaming out. She held her hand nonetheless, "It's a boy." The babe was wrapped in purple fabric, placed on her chest, "The heir shall be strong." With her free hand she touched it close to her heart.

"He looks like you." Light Spinner whispered against her cheek, her lips pressed against her temples.

"Thank you." She squeezed her hand more gently this time, her voice half gone. "For all. I am forever in your debt. Whatever you shall ask of me, you shall have." Her own lips pressed to her son. She washed him in her tears and sweat, her heart as big as a dragon.

Days went on, weeks came and disappeared, her son was three months mature. Atreyu had cared for him until the first week of his life,until the formal ceremony, where his father passed its claim to him, and lifted the boy under the full moons. The Lunarium was full, and her son was named heir to the new Head Sorcerer. Atreyu did not care to share the same bed as her, or the same dining room most days, he had new duties now. She spent her days with the babe, and she cherished each moment anew. Once again she was rested and in full health.

Light Spinner was retrieved of her duty once the boy was named heir and she had not seen her since. Well, unless she counted the times she watched her tend to her plants from her place on the balcony. She missed the woman's calming energy and her safe presence. Her heart yearned for the friend she had gained in the past year. The taste of the peppermint was long gone from her tongue.

Rhunton loved the sun, like she knew he did, and he did not even cry when they bathed him in the salty seas. If anything her son was most calm on the beaches of Mystacor, on the meadow where her friend had braided her hair.

On every night of the full moons, three deep red roses would find their way to the rail of her balcony. Sometimes she would keep them by her bed, other times she'd throw them down the sea as a gift for her son.

She had laid her blanket there on purpose, she knew she'd be there, tending her roses and her snow daisies. Rhunton rested peacefully on her lap, random sounds leaving his mouth. Her heart grew even more when she saw her and she thought for a second Light Spinner missed her too.

"Light Spinner." She greeted with a smile though there was the tiniest bit of doubt that the sorceress had only ever seen her as a duty finished.

"Castaspella." She walked closer, her roses left behind, "You look well." Her figure towered over her.

"Sit with me." Her hand tapped the blanket, her voice unhinged, but her eyes pleading. "Rhunton missed you." The boy babbled his sounds.

Light Spinner chuckled in that clinical, unbelievable way of hers, but she sat nonetheless, and she had to fight the urge to grab her hand like on the day her son came to the world. "You have not been around."

"I am busy." The green of her eyes brought back the taste of the peppermint, "As are you I assume."

"I always have time for a cup of tea." Light Spinner nodded, "Do you not wish to meet my son? You more than anyone had kept him here."

"I do wish." Her blue glowing fingers touched the boy's stomach, drawing her spell. The red dragon walked over her son, blowing fire and Rhunton laughed, he had started to do that. Castaspella laughed too.

"I told you he likes you."

"He likes my magic."

The dragon puffed away as she lifted the boy putting him in Light Spinner's arms, he did not cry or fuss, babbling even louder. "He likes *you.* I know your presence calms him. It always has." She rested her hand on the sorceress' shoulder. "Come around more."

"It is better if I do not."

"Why?"

"I have come to see you differently in these months." Her voice was low like the day she whispered in her ear.

Her smile fell into a thin line. "What do you mean? Why are you talking so weirdly? I can not follow you."

"I do not wish to bring your promises into question." Her son was back in her arms. She was frowning. "You do things to me…I-" Light Spinner started to get up, dusting her skirts in a hurry.

She grabbed her wrist holding her down. "I do not understand a single thing when you go on like this." Slightly annoyed, she put Rhunton into his carry-on bed, it looked like a basket for fruits or flowers, layered with soft fabrics. "If you do not wish to spend time with me you can say so. There is no need to make a fuss and circle around it. I really do not-" She turned back to look at her, but Light Spinner was close and her lips stole her remaining words. No one other than her husband had ever kissed her in such a way. Yet if she was honest, truly honest, he had never kissed her like that.

Light Spinner's kiss lingered her lips and Castaspella could not help but to close her eyes shut. Her heart did odd things, jumping from her chest to her stomach. Instinctively she started to lower herself against the soft blanket, letting the sorceress tower over her, letting her kiss her in the middle of the meadow. Yet even such impulsive actions have to meet their end.

So Light Spinner was off of her in a split moment, "First Ones." dusting her skirts, fixing her hair, "Forgive me." She glanced at her. "This is why it's better if we do not see each other."

"Wait." But the sorceress was gone, her steps long and fast.

"Give this to Light Spinner." She told her maid on the morning of the ceremony, handing her a sealed scroll.

"Yes, my lady." She had written her in her best cursive, sealed it with the most expensive waxes. Though only 2 sentences were written.

Find me on the beach tonight. Do not come and I shall let you be forever.

C.

She washed herself in salt and let her hair come down. Her arm she wrapped in her wedding ribbon, her dress light and creamy flew in the night's wind. Rhunton was placed with the maids like in all the other ceremonies. She remembered the book she read on the meadow, the same meadow Light Spinner had kissed her on. The story of princess Fharaele. Her head recited the words of it over and over again as her bare feet dug under the sand with each new wave. Her arms were crossed over her chest and she played with the silky fabric, she watched where the sea met the starry sky.

Her voice came to life as she heard the light ruffles, “You came.” , she did not need to turn around to know her or perhaps she was not ready to meet her gaze.

“What do you want, Castaspella?”

She still stood with her front to the sea, “Do you know the story of princess Fharaele?” Light Spinner did not answer her and she went on, “Do you know of the old ways?”

“I know enough about your ways. What do you want?”

“Her promises were broken in the way of the old royals.” She turned around and burnt her eyes into hers, “Under the moons.” Her feet took a step forward, leaving the shore, she did not let her voice get intimidated by her green gaze, “Take me here, break my promise, in the ways I follow and I will not say a word against it.”

“You have no idea what you’re saying right now.” Light Spinner stood as firm as Castaspella herself, “This is treason, I would lose my status, you, your son, for what, a one night adventure.”

“I am not offering myself to you as an adventure, and if you see me as such, you might as well turn around now.” They stood face to face, and she had to swallow the wariness that dared to bubble with her words. “Do you know the old ways?” Light Spinner nodded, still not believing her words. “No one is standing in your way.” She ripped the runestone off of the sorceress’ chest, grabbing her arm she pressed it against her palm. “Only by the old ways…” The full moons glimmered over her hair, over her tea like eyes. “My marriage is a loveless one, I did my duty, I will not break my promise on my own accord, but-” She pressed their

hands together the runestone with its crystal stood between them, “You can.”

Her throat was tight as she tried to read her face, yet she could not, “What happens if I choose to take you here, in the ways that have not been practiced for ages.No one has broken another’s promise in-”

“It will be legitimate.I shall be yours like I am now my husband’s” She took a step back, “and in a way I have never been anyone’s because I have started to see you in a different way too, despite my initial blindness to what was in front of my eyes.”

Light Spinner’s hand squeezed around the runestone she wore on her dress every single day, her eyes moved from Castaspella’s to the the veil she laid on the beach like on the night she was wed, another in the color of aronia, in the sorceress’ colors was folded next to it.

“Turn around.” With her jumping heart, she did, her skin chilling as the slim fingers touched her neck, moving her hair out of the way. The runestone grazed her back and her lips pressed together as her dress was cut open falling down, she did not care to wear anything below it. Warm lips touched her shoulder and her neck, behind her ear and she was gone. Light Spinner spinned her around, and their eyes met, “May the moons justify my will.” The sorceress started to speak Castaspella’s ways, “For I can not stop myself even under your promises.” The runestone rested on her arm, over her ribbon. She knew the words, “May the moons and the waves and this island that has floated for centuries know that you are now mine.” The ribbon started to fall apart as the sharp stone went over it, “No person’s will shall break mine, for a

promise can only be broken once.” It fell against the sand over her dress, the runestone fell on the veil as did the two of them. “And yours with this are broken.” Their lips crashed together and Light Spinner held her hands in the same death grip she once held hers, intertwined fingers pressed them to the veil, to the sand, as she had her way with her. She took her just how Castaspella imagined she would, she did not hurt her, but she made her feel things she never dreamt of. She made her see stars, she made her cry out from emotions.

Light Spinner led her to the sea and she dipped her under it and even with her dress on she followed Castaspella below the waves, kissing her lips, pressing them close, she took her again and she wrapped her in a new color, her old veil ripped in two before the runestone was attached back against the sorceress’ drenched dress. Her tears spilled from happiness that night and she was married anew under the full moons as her witnesses.

End Notes

comments and kudos are as always welcome. i hope you liked it :)

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